X402 + WEBMCP, MEASURED

An AI agent paid for a web tool call.

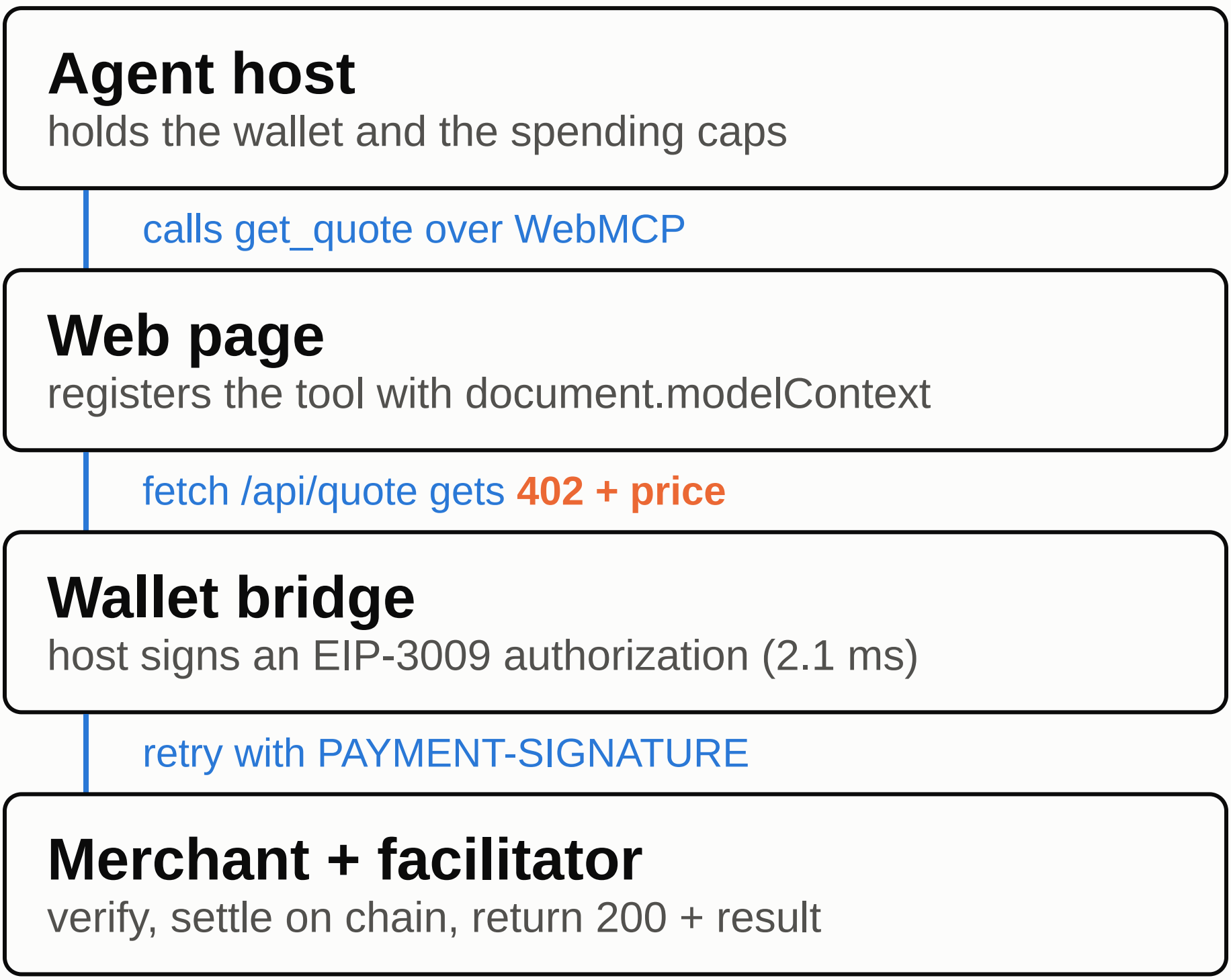
262 ms

Median, with 200 ms blocks. No human. No API key.

Local test chain, test token. Swipe for the method, the numbers and what is fake.

HOW IT WORKS

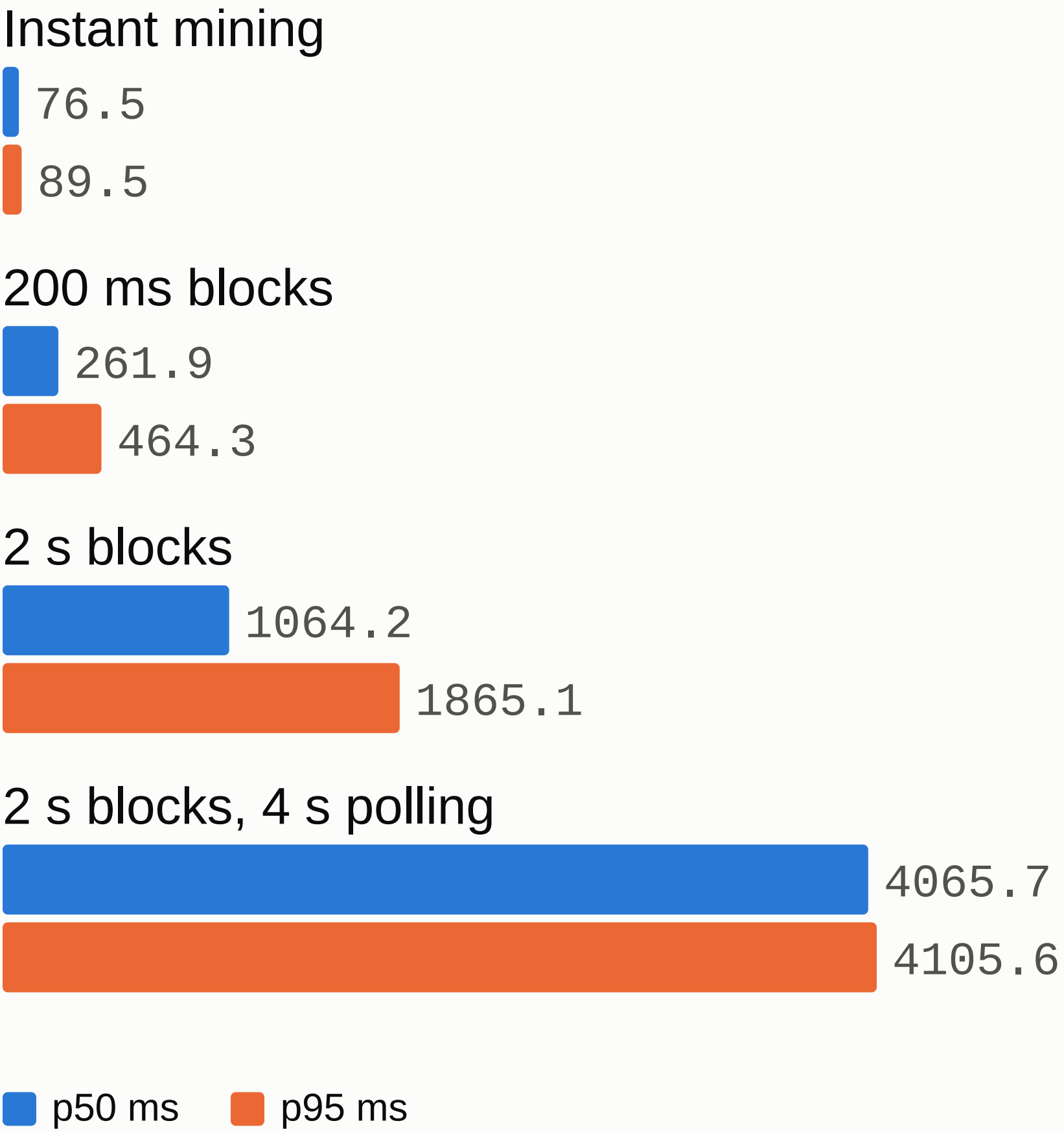
One tool call, one 402, one signature.



The page never holds a key.

LATENCY, 25 RUNS PER ROW

The payment is the latency.



Source: results.json, tool call to result, one axis from 0.

WHERE 262 MS GOES (200 MS BLOCKS, P50)

Settling on chain is almost all of it.

Facilitator settle	**234.9 ms**
Facilitator verify	**16.9 ms**
Wallet sign	**2.1 ms**
Tool discovery (getTools)	**1.3 ms**

The WebMCP part costs about 1 ms. Block time sets the rest.

Source: results.json. Discovery figure from README.

THE GOTCHA

One default turned 1.06 s into 4.07 s.

2 s blocks, receipt polling 200 ms	same chain, viem default 4 s polling
1 064 ms	**4 066 ms**

viem checks for a receipt every 4 s. The settle waited for the poll, not the block.

```
pollingInterval: 200
```

Median tool call, 25 runs each. Source: results.json.

REAL VS TEST

What you can trust, and what you cannot.

Real

- Chromium 158.0.8127.18 with native WebMCP
- Official x402 SDK 2.30.0
- EIP-712 signing, on-chain transfer
- Spend caps and replay protection

Test

- Local ganache chain
- Own test token, not USDC
- Facilitator runs on loopback
- A script, not an LLM
- The wallet bridge is my invention

A hosted facilitator and a real RPC add round trips I did not measure.

THE OPEN PROBLEM

Who holds the agent's wallet?

WebMCP has no payment or wallet hook. The page can ask for money. Something else has to sign.

- The browser
- The model vendor
- You

Every demo I found keeps the key in the page or its server.

RUN IT YOURSELF

Code, method and raw numbers.

github.com/Egoushka/x402-webm cp-lab

```
npm install
npm test
```

MIT. Four scenarios, 25 runs each.

Who should hold the wallet? Tell me in the comments.